DATA AND STRATEGY PORTFOLIO · CASE STUDY

INSIGHT AND STRATEGY PACK

Organisational Strategy Use Case

From pipeline data to portfolio decisions

This deck is the final layer of an end-to-end insight pack. It takes one anonymised admissions dataset from raw data, through a Power BI dashboard, to analysis, recommendations and organisational strategy. A focused showcase of working across the whole pipeline: from data to decisions.

01 Anonymised raw data → 02 Power BI dashboard → 03 **Insight and strategy deck**

This deck

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All data anonymised: institution shown as UNI A, schools as A to E

TODAY'S DISCUSSION

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Demand is not the problem. Conversion after the offer is

One applicant in eight enrols. The loss sits after the offer and in overseas recruitment, and headline averages hide it.

APPLICANTS	OFFER RATE	MADE UNCONDITIONAL	ENROLLED OF UNCONDITIONAL	OVERALL CONVERSION
62,180	63.6%	56.4%	33.2%	11.9%
2024/25 cycle snapshot	39,533 offers	of offers · 22,311	the weakest stage	7,415 enrolled · 12.7% like-for-like

FIVE FINDINGS

1. **Overseas fills the funnel, home fills the seats.** Overseas is 64% of applicants but 49% of enrolments, and falls behind at every stage.
2. **The PG gap is an overseas gap.** Home postgraduates convert at 21.2%, ahead of home undergraduates (20.6%). Overseas PG converts at 8.2%.
3. **The school league table flips like-for-like.** PGCE courses carry 11% of applicants at 3.1% conversion. Without them, School C goes from lowest (10.0%) to highest (16.5%).
4. **A small core carries the portfolio.** 48 of 535 courses deliver half of all enrolments; 269 enrol five or fewer.
5. **Growth rests on one market.** UNI A outgrew the sector (+6.0% vs +2.8%) on non-EU demand while home (-6.0%) and EU (-44%) fell faster than the market.

WHAT FOLLOWS

CONVERT
Close the overseas post-offer gap

CONVERT
Target overseas PG conversion

MEASURE
Report schools like-for-like

SHAPE
Rationalise the long tail

REBALANCE
Grow home and part-time demand

02

FROM APPLICATION TO ENROLMENT

The pipeline

62,180 applicants to 7,415 enrolments, stage by stage.

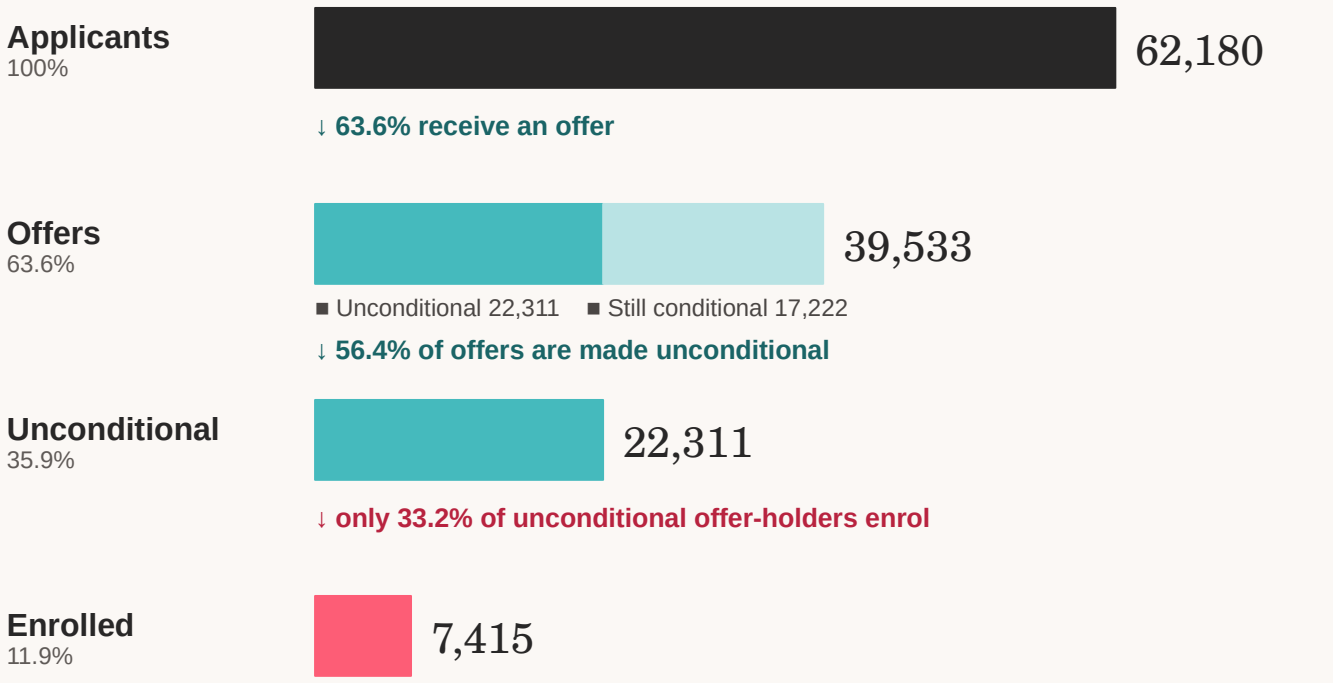
Slide 5

Most of the loss happens after an unconditional offer

Nearly two in three applicants get an offer, but two in three unconditional offer-holders still do not enrol.

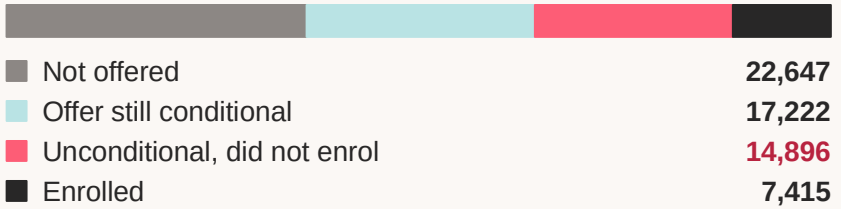
APPLICANTS TO ENROLMENTS, 2024/25

Bar length = share of applicants



Read top to bottom: **the steepest drop is the last one**, from unconditional offer to enrolment.

WHERE THE 62,180 END UP



Not offered	**22,647**
Offer still conditional	**17,222**
Unconditional, did not enrol	**14,896**
Enrolled	**7,415**

THE LEVER

~220 extra enrolments for every one-point gain in unconditional-to-enrolment conversion.

READ WITH CARE

4,038 applicants carry an unassessed "Other" fee status and only 4 enrol. Excluding them, conversion is **12.7%**.

So what: the fastest gain is post-offer conversion. Same demand, more students.

03

THE SEGMENTS

Where it leaks

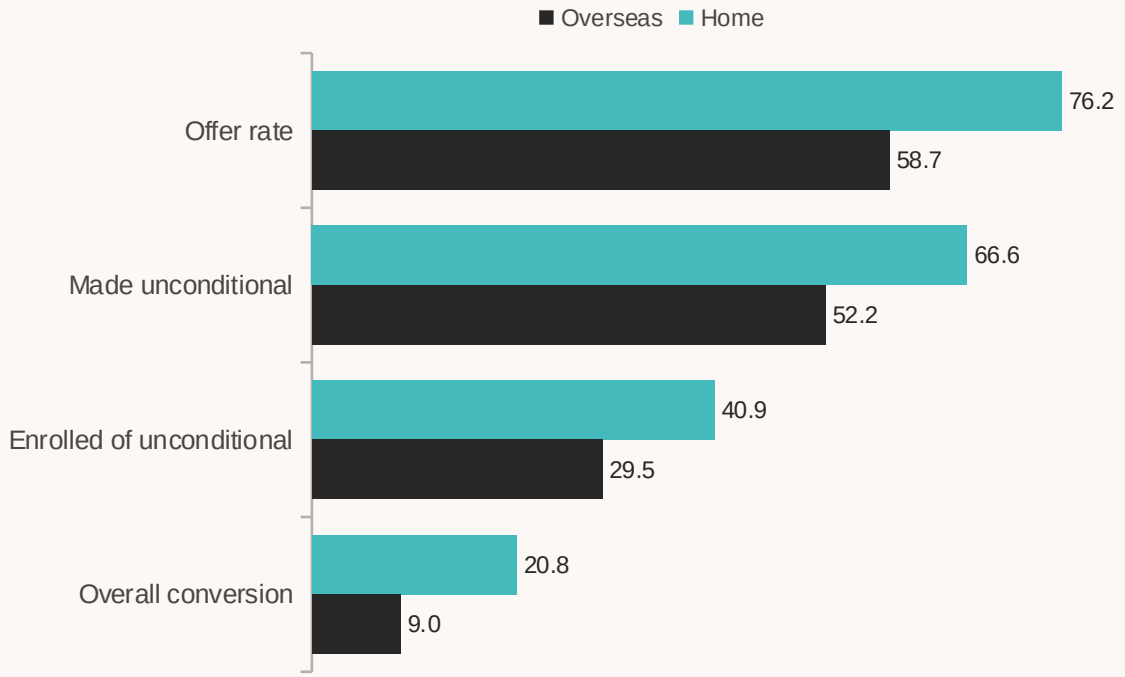
Fee status, level, school and course: where conversion is won and lost.

Slides 7 to 10

Overseas demand fills the funnel. Home demand fills the seats

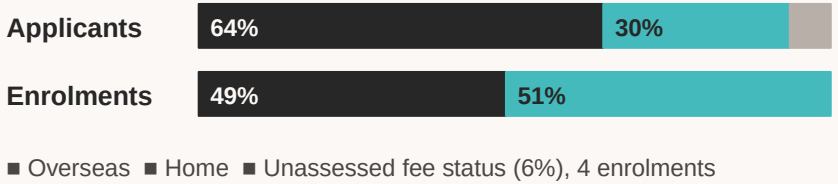
Overseas applicants are 64% of the pipeline but 49% of enrolments, and they fall behind at every stage.

CONVERSION AT EACH STAGE, %



Each stage compounds: **an overseas applicant is less than half as likely to enrol** as a home applicant (9.0% vs 20.8%).

SHARE OF THE PIPELINE



■ Overseas ■ Home ■ Unassessed fee status (6%), 4 enrolments

THE PRIZE

~120

enrolments per one-point gain in overseas unconditional-to-enrolment

~690

if half the gap to home closes (29.5% to 35.2%)

So what: the overseas leak is post-offer (deposit, CAS and visa stages), not demand. Run it as a conversion programme, not a recruitment one.

Insights · Admissions Portfolio Dashboard 2024/25 · home 18,360 and overseas 39,782 applicants · prize assumes current overseas unconditional volume (12,184)

The postgraduate gap is an overseas gap

Home postgraduates convert as well as home undergraduates. The headline PG rate is pulled down by overseas volume.

CONVERSION BY LEVEL AND FEE STATUS (ENROLLED ÷ APPLICANTS)

	UNDERGRADUATE	POSTGRADUATE
HOME	20.6% 14,185 applicants · 2,919 enrolled	21.2% HIGHEST 4,159 applicants · 880 enrolled
OVERSEAS	11.0% 12,131 applicants · 1,330 enrolled	8.2% 44% OF ALL APPLICANTS 27,651 applicants · 2,270 enrolled

The dashboard view (**UG 14.7%, PG 9.5%**) reads as a level problem. Split by fee status, **home PG leads**.

WHERE OVERSEAS PG DROPS

	Home PG	Overseas PG
Offer rate	42.4%	58.7%
Made unconditional	80.0%	54.3%
Enrolled of unconditional	62.4%	**25.8%**

Overseas PG gets more offers, then loses three in four after the offer turns unconditional.

PART-TIME: SMALL BUT STICKY

24.2% conversion on 1,668 applicants (2.7%). 79% of offers turn unconditional, against 56% full-time.

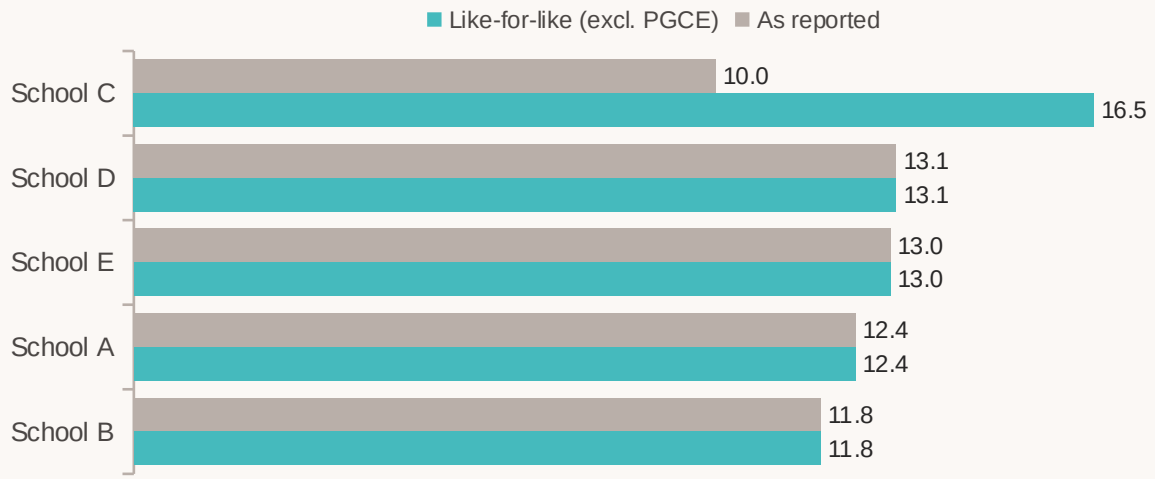
So what: fix overseas PG conversion, not PG pricing. It is 44% of all applicants and converts at 8.2%.

Insights · Admissions Portfolio Dashboard 2024/25 · excludes unassessed fee status and 16 "other level" applicants

Like-for-like, the school league table flips

51 PGCE courses carry 11% of all applicants but convert at 3.1%, and every one sits in School C.

CONVERSION BY SCHOOL, %



School	Applicants	Offer rate	Reported	Like-for-like	Rank
C	13,812	**38.9%**	10.0%	**16.5%**	**5th → 1st**
D	9,900	63.2%	13.1%	13.1%	1st → 2nd
E	16,526	72.8%	13.0%	13.0%	2nd → 3rd
A	3,174	86.0%	12.4%	12.4%	3rd → 4th
B	18,768	69.9%	11.8%	11.8%	4th → 5th

THE PGCE EFFECT

6,751 applicants → 520 offers → 209 enrolled

An offer rate of 7.7% and conversion of 3.1%: a different kind of pipeline, not a weak school.

OVERSEAS PGCE

22 enrolments from 3,681 overseas PGCE applicants (0.6%). Likely route-specific entry rules; worth validating with admissions.

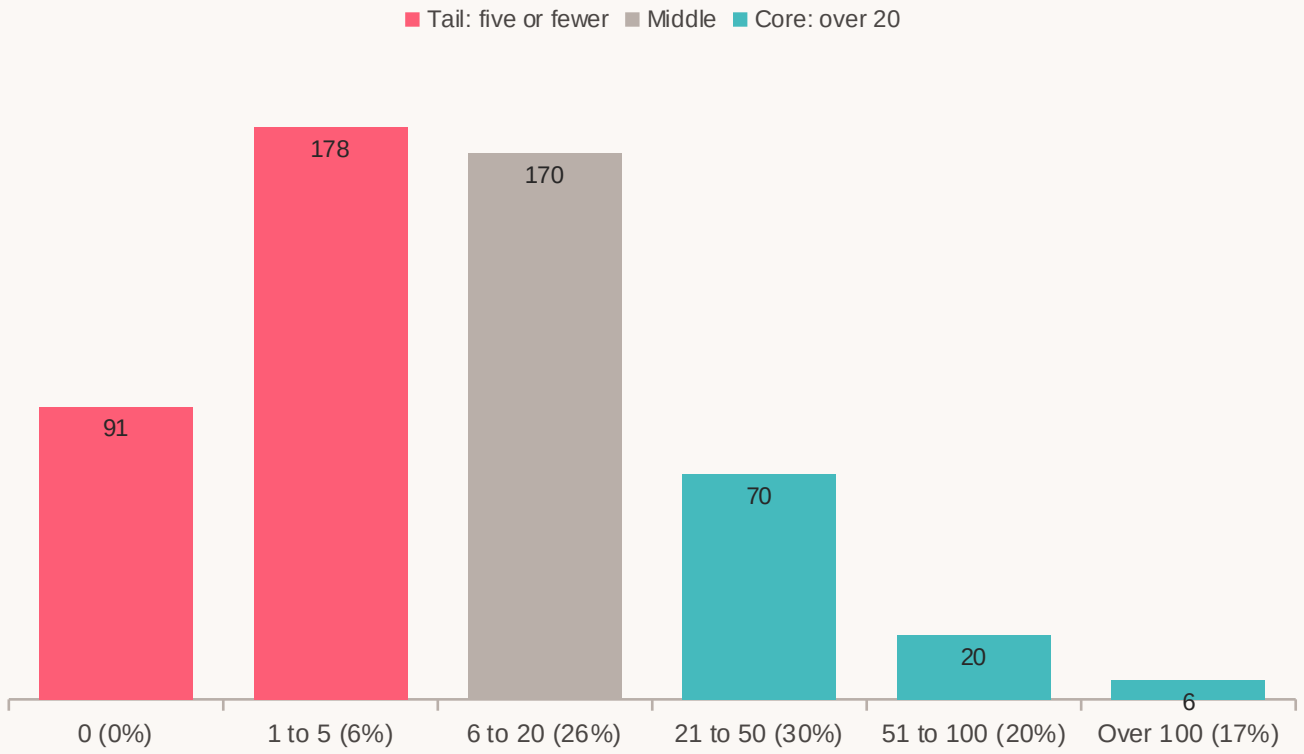
So what: report schools like-for-like, and give PGCE its own pipeline, targets and applicant guidance.

Insights · Admissions Portfolio Dashboard 2024/25 · PGCE = course titles containing PGCE (51 courses, all School C)

A small core carries the portfolio

48 of 535 courses deliver half of all enrolments. Half of the courses enrol five students or fewer.

COURSES BY NUMBER OF ENROLMENTS (SHARE OF ALL ENROLMENTS IN LABELS)



Read left to right: **269 courses (coral) hold 6% of enrolments**; 96 courses (teal) hold 68%.

HALF OF ENROLMENTS

48
courses (9%)

80% OF ENROLMENTS

153
courses (29%)

THE CORE: TOP FIVE BY ENROLMENTS

Course · school	Enrolled	Conv.
Business Management BSc · B	**405**	15.3%
Computer Science BSc · E	**313**	16.5%
Hospitality Management BA · B	**157**	**27.5%**
Computer Science (Placement) MSc · E	**148**	14.2%
Adult Nursing BSc · D	**130**	**8.4%**

So what: protect and grow the core; review the 269 courses with five or fewer enrolments for consolidation into pathways, or closure.

Insights · Admissions Portfolio Dashboard 2024/25 · course = recruiting title, all modes and fee statuses combined

04

HESA CONTEXT

The market

How UNI A's growth compares with the sector, 2018/19 to 2022/23.

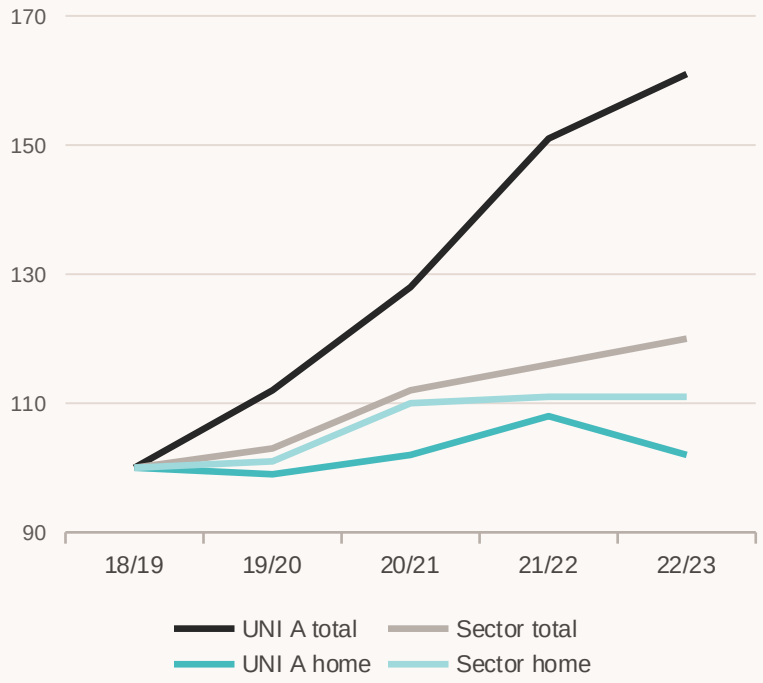
Slides 12 and 13

Five years of growth, built on non-EU students

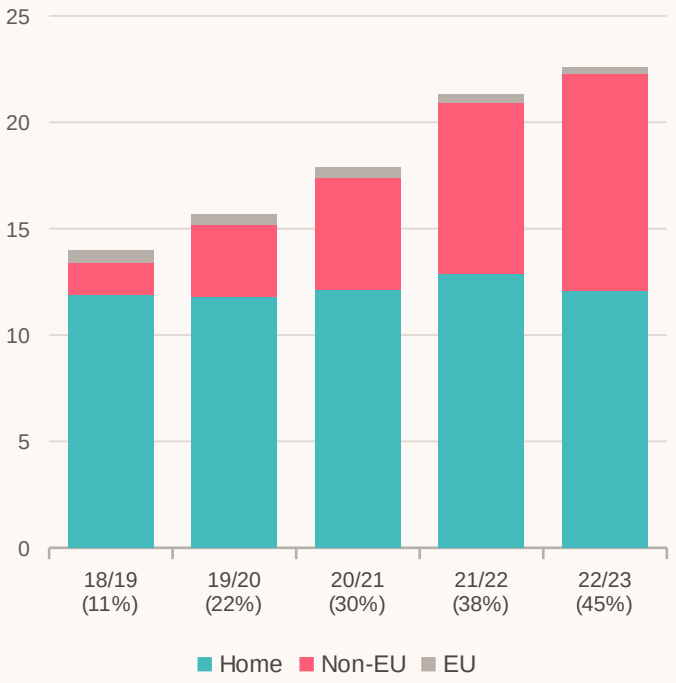
UNI A grew three times faster than the sector since 2018/19, almost entirely through non-EU recruitment. Home demand has stalled.

▲ +61%	UNI A enrolments in five years, against +20% for the sector
▲ ~7x	non-EU enrolments since 2018/19, from about 1,500 to 10,200
▼ 85→54%	home share of UNI A students since 2018/19
▼ -6.0%	home enrolments last year, against -0.3% for the sector

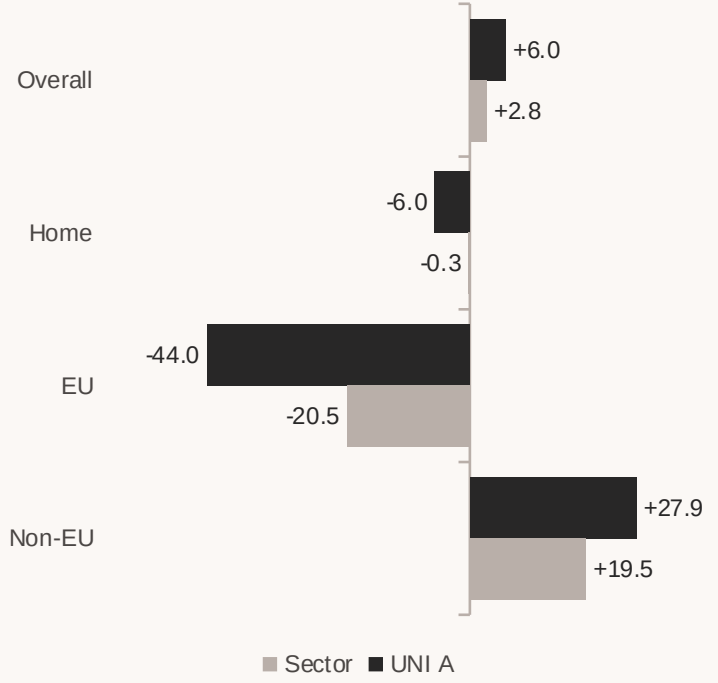
1 · GROWTH, INDEXED (2018/19 = 100)



2 · UNI A MIX, THOUSANDS (NON-EU SHARE)



3 · LAST YEAR, 2021/22 TO 2022/23, %



SO WHAT

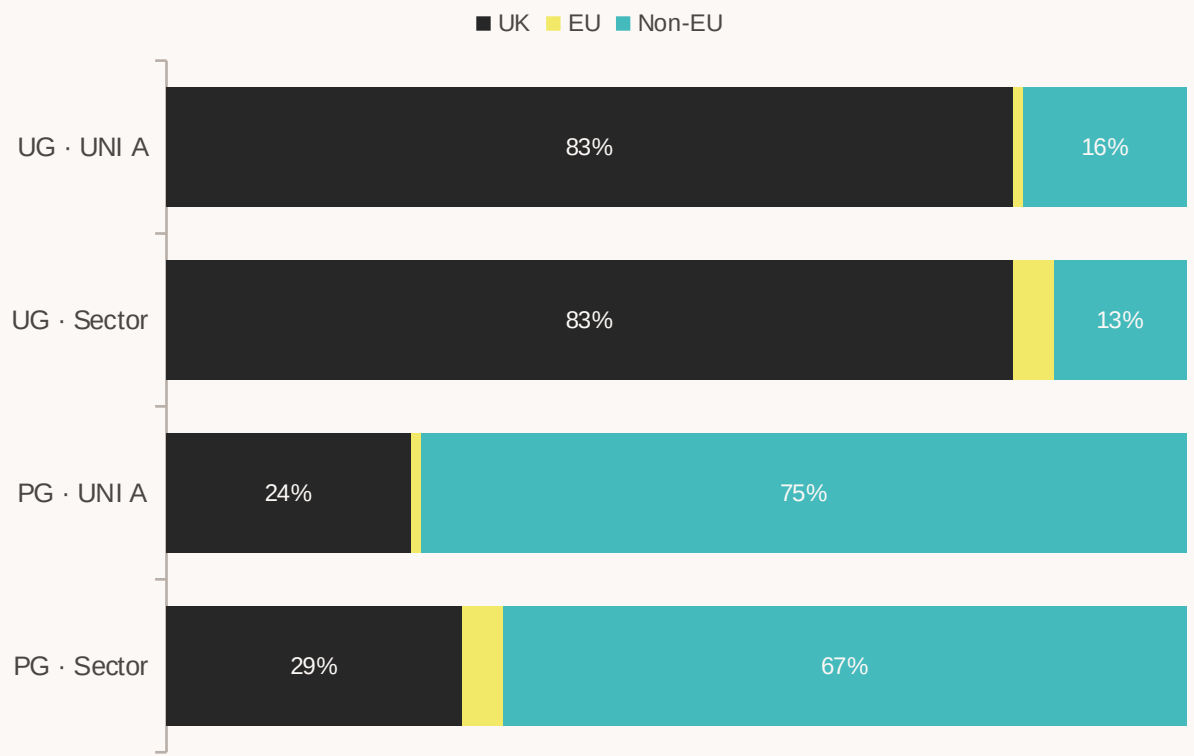
Growth rests on one market as the levy (£925 per student from 2028) and an 18-month Graduate Route (from 2027) arrive. Rebuilding home demand is resilience.

The market · HESA open data, 2018/19 to 2022/23 · five-year values approximate, read from the published series · growth rates as published

Postgraduate is more international than the sector

Undergraduate mix mirrors the market. Postgraduate leans further to non-EU, and three subject areas carry half the student body.

DOMICILE MIX, 2022/23, %



EU is under-represented at both levels (1% against 4%): **a small but open market**.

SUBJECT SHARE: UNI A AGAINST THE UK (CAH1)

Area	UNI A	UK
Business and management 5,305 students · 82% international PG · UK +17%	**27%**	20%
Subjects allied to medicine 2,475 students · stable, home-led demand	13%	13%
Computing 1,965 students · fastest-growing area, UK +23%	**10%**	6%

UNDER-INDEXED

Law, social sciences, and engineering and physical sciences sit below national share: options to test, not gaps to fill.

So what: lean into business and computing where UNI A over-indexes and the market grows; use allied health as the home-demand anchor.

The market · HESA open data 2022/23 · CAH1 subject areas · UNI A PG shares as published (rounded)

05

THE PLAYS

What to do

Five moves, how to measure them, and the risks to watch.

Slides 15 to 17

Five moves to lift enrolment

Two convert existing demand; three make the portfolio more resilient. Each has an owner and a measure.

	The move	The evidence	Owner	Measure of success	Horizon
1	Close the overseas post-offer gap CONVERT	Unconditional-to-enrolment 29.5% overseas vs 40.9% home. +1 point ≈ 120 students.	International, Admissions	Overseas unconditional-to-enrolment; deposit and CAS conversion	**Next cycle**
2	Target overseas PG conversion CONVERT	44% of all applicants convert at 8.2%; three in four are lost after the offer turns unconditional.	International, Schools B and E	Overseas PG conversion by course; time from offer to deposit	**Next cycle**
3	Report schools like-for-like MEASURE	Removing PGCE moves School C from 10.0% (lowest) to 16.5% (highest).	Planning, School C	School conversion excluding PGCE; PGCE tracked as its own pipeline	**Immediate**
4	Rationalise the long tail SHAPE	269 of 535 courses enrol five or fewer and hold 6% of enrolments.	Portfolio board, Deans	Courses below a viability threshold; enrolments per course	**One to two cycles**
5	Grow home and part-time demand REBALANCE	Home enrolments -6.0% against a flat sector; part-time converts at 24.2%.	Marketing, Schools	Home share of enrolments; part-time and flexible applications	**Two to three cycles**

RECOMMENDATION Start with moves 1 and 2: the same demand, more students, inside one cycle. Moves 3 to 5 make the growth durable.

What to do · owners are suggested functions, to be agreed · evidence from slides 5 to 13

What to track, what to fix, what could change the picture

A stage-based scorecard keeps every move measurable; three data fixes make it trustworthy.

TRACK

A stage-based scorecard

Measure	Today
Offer rate, overseas	**58.7%**
Made unconditional, overseas	**52.2%**
Unconditional to enrolled, overseas	**29.5%**
Overseas PG conversion	**8.2%**
School conversion, like-for-like	**11.8 to 16.5%**
Courses with five or fewer enrolled	**269**
Home share of enrolments	**51.4%**

Baseline 2024/25. Set targets against prior year and sector, not against the average.

FIX

Three data improvements

1 · Resolve unassessed fee status

4,038 applicants (6.5%) sit in "Other" with 4 enrolments, which distorts every rate.

2 · Add trend and target lines

Every stage needs prior-year and target comparisons, so the dashboard shows change, not just a snapshot.

3 · Benchmark externally

Align courses to CAH subjects and compare with UCAS and HESA, so performance is read against the market.

WATCH

Policy risks to the plan

International student levy

£925 per international student from August 2028, a direct cost on the segment that drives growth.

Graduate Route cut to 18 months

From January 2027, weakening the post-study work offer that shapes overseas choice.

Tighter visa compliance

A lower visa refusal threshold makes market selection and agent quality part of conversion.

NEXT STEP

Build the stage-by-stage conversion view into the admissions dashboard, so every move above has a live measure.

Measure and watch · baselines from slides 5 to 10 · policy as announced at the time of writing

APPENDIX

Method and data notes

SOURCES

Admissions Portfolio Dashboard, 2024/25 cycle snapshot: 1,627 rows by school, course, mode, fee status and level (Power BI).

HESA open data and statistical releases, 2018/19 to 2022/23, for sector comparison, domicile mix and CAH1 subjects.

DEFINITIONS

Offer rate = offers ÷ applicants

Made unconditional = unconditional offers ÷ offers

Enrolled of unconditional = enrolments ÷ unconditional offers

Conversion = enrolments ÷ applicants

Like-for-like = excluding unassessed fee status, or PGCE for school comparisons, as stated

CAVEATS

Snapshot. Conditional offers may still convert after it was taken.

HESA trends. Five-year values on slide 12 are approximate, read from the published series; growth rates are as published.

Anonymised for portfolio use: institution shown as UNI A, schools as A to E.

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